3. His/her work and conduct cannot be discussed and criticised in the Lok Sabha except on a substantive motion.

4. His/her powers of regulating procedure or conducting business or maintaining order in the House are not subject to the jurisdiction of any Court.

5. He/she cannot vote in the first instance. He/she can only exercise a casting vote in the event of a tie. This makes the position of Speaker impartial.

6. He/she is given a very high position in the order of precedence. He/she is placed at seventh rank, along with the Chief Justice of India. This means, he/she has a higher rank than all cabinet ministers, except the Prime Minister or Deputy Prime Minister.

In Britain, the Speaker is strictly a non-party man. There is a convention that the Speaker has to resign from his/her party and remain politically neutral. This healthy convention is not fully established in India where the Speaker does not resign from the membership of his/her party on his/her election to the exalted office.

 **Deputy Speaker of Lok Sabha**

Like the Speaker, the Deputy Speaker is also elected by the Lok Sabha itself from amongst its members. He/she is elected after the election of the Speaker has taken place. The date of election of the Deputy Speaker is fixed by the Speaker. Whenever the office of the Deputy Speaker falls vacant, the Lok Sabha elects another member to fill the vacancy.

Like the Speaker, the Deputy Speaker remains in office usually during the life of the Lok Sabha. However, he/she may vacate his/her office earlier in any of the following three cases:

1. if he/she ceases to be a member of the Lok Sabha;

2. if he/she resigns by writing to the Speaker; and

3. if he/she is removed by a resolution passed by a majority of all the then members of the Lok Sabha(i.e., an effective majority). Such a resolution can be moved only after giving 14 days' advance notice.

The Deputy Speaker performs the duties of the Speaker's office when it is vacant. He/she also acts as the Speaker when the latter is absent from the sitting of the House. In both the cases, he/she assumes all the powers of the Speaker. He/she also presides over the joint sitting of both the Houses of Parliament, in case the Speaker is absent from such a sitting.

It should be noted here that the Deputy Speaker is not subordinate to the Speaker. He/she is directly responsible to the House.

The Deputy Speaker has one special privilege, that is, whenever he/she is appointed as a member of a parliamentary committee, he/she automatically becomes its chairman.

Like the Speaker, the Deputy Speaker, while presiding over the House, cannot vote in the first instance; he/she can only exercise a casting vote in the case of a tie. Further, when a resolution for the removal of